

How to use this book

A map is a drawing that gives an overall view of a place. The maps in this book show parts of the world at different times in history. The countries and territories these maps show often look very different from how these same places appear today.

Outside areas

Around the edges of many of the maps are other land areas. These are shown in a cream color.

Dates

On the map, dates are shown in bold, to help you find your way around the page.

Picture features

Pictures with text highlight special features, including buildings and battles.

Important cities

Capital cities are marked with red outlines. Other cities are outlined in blue.

Ancient Rome

More than 2,000 years ago, ancient Rome was one of the most powerful nations in the world. At first, Rome was ruled by kings. It became a republic in 509 BCE, which meant that it was ruled by members of Roman society. In 27 BCE Rome became an empire, led by a ruler called an emperor. At its largest, in 117 CE, the Roman Empire was home to more than 65 million people.

Snapshots

These images add extra information about historical events, people, and places.

Key

The key gives information about the picture symbols on the map.

Punic Wars
Between 264 and 146 BCE, Rome fought three wars against the city of Carthage, in modern-day Tunisia. Rome wanted control of the Mediterranean Sea. The wars, known as the Punic Wars, ended in total Roman victory.



General Hannibal from Carthage

KEY (c.117 CE)

- Empire border**
The edge of the Roman Empire.
- Grain**
Shipped to Rome from North Africa and Sicily.
- Grapevines**
Vines were planted across the empire to grow grapes to make into wine.
- Timber**
Forests were stripped of wood all over the empire.
- Roman baths**
Public bathing brought the Romans together.
- Slaves**
Many Romans owned slaves. Some slaves had to build Roman roads.
- Amphitheaters**
Open-air theaters entertained Romans across the empire.
- Roman soldiers**
The army kept the peace and defended the borders against enemy invasion.

Date

Some of the keys have a date to show the time period of the map. If the date includes "c.," it means "circa," or "around"—meaning the date isn't exact.

Compass

The compass always points to north (N) on the map and also shows the direction of south (S), east (E), and west (W).

Picture symbols

You will find picture symbols without text on some of the maps. Look at the key to find out what each symbol means.

Scale

The scale indicates the size of the country and the distances between different points on the map.



The Appian Way leading out of Rome

Roman roads

The Romans built many long, straight roads to link the towns and cities of the empire. Paved roads helped soldiers march quickly around the empire.

The city of Pompeii was destroyed by the eruption of the volcano Mount Vesuvius in 79 CE.

The Romans built this amphitheater in what is now Tunisia.

An important city in Roman Libya.